

ADANI AIRPORTS FLYING HIGH ON REMARKABLE PERFORMANCE

India's air cargo market is brimming with optimism. Flying high on a remarkable performance in 2023 and a promising outlook for the coming years, the industry is making its mark as one of the most essential mediums of transporting goods. Domestic air cargo saw a significant rise in 2023-24, clocking around 13.2 million metric tonnes of cargo in both passenger and freight aircraft and – it was around 12.8 million metric tonnes in 2022-23. India ranks 12th globally and Indian air freight market is estimated to reach \$17.22 billion by 2028 from \$13.08 billion in 2023, according to a report by Research and Markets.

Adani Airport Holdings Ltd (AAHL), a subsidiary of Adani Group, is one of the leading airport operators in India. It owns and operates seven airports across the country, namely Mumbai, Ahmedabad, Lucknow, Mangaluru, Jaipur, Guwahati, and Thiruvananthapuram. The Navi Mumbai International Airport is likely to be completed by mid of next year. Adani Airports has been expanding its cargo operations to meet the growing demand for air freight in India and abroad.

Eyes set on exploiting the potential of this sector to achieve the target of 10 million tonnes by 2030, the Ministry of Civil Aviation and the Airports Authority of India (AAI) are driving initiatives to develop airport infrastructure, logistics parks, and extensive road connectivity projects across the nation. The Central Government is undertaking 13 such projects under Sagarmala programme and 35 multi-modal logistics parks (MMLPs) under Bharatmala Phase I. The Adani Group operates 11 MMLPs across the country.

RECORD CARGO HANDLING AND MILESTONE

In FY 2023-24 ending March, cargo in and out of Indian airports were up 7% year-on-year, touching 3.4 million metric tonnes, according to AAI data. Out of this, AAHL alone handled 1 million metric tonnes. This milestone underscores AAHL's robust operational capabilities and strategic growth in the aviation industry. Demonstrat-

ing solid growth, Adani Airports facilitated a remarkable 10,13,115 metric tonnes of cargo in FY 2023-24, capturing an impressive 30.1% market share.

Most of the cargo – 65% – handled by AAHL was international. The international cargo tonnage amounted to 6,62,258 metric tonnes as compared to previous fiscal's 6,06,348 metric tonnes. The cargo operations were driven by commodities like automobiles, pharmaceuticals, perishables, electricals/ electronics, and engineering goods. The major international destinations for cargo were Germany, Netherlands, the United Arab Emirates, the United Kingdom and the United States of America.

WHAT KEEPS AAHL AHEAD OF ITS COMPETITORS

The company's unique focus areas set it apart from a conventional cargo terminal operator:

- Focus on integrated network of logistics
- Multi modal logistics integration
- Focus on automation & IT integration
- Leverage of 8 airports, which enhances synergy among various stations

The company attributes its success in cargo handling to factors like strategic location, modern infrastructure, digital solutions, and customer-centric approach. It

also credits its partnerships with airlines, cargo agents, freight forwarders, and other stakeholders for enhancing its cargo network and connectivity. AAHL is committed to providing world-class cargo services and facilities to its clients and contributing to the growth of the Indian economy.

AAHL's state-of-the-art projects enable the company to provide world-class environment at the airports. The most important project that AAHL is rolling out at all the airports is Integrated Cargo Terminal (ICT) – a world-class cargo terminal with single roof concept, i.e., international (export/import/perishable/pharma) and domestic (outbound/inbound/cold chain) products under one roof. ICT will be capable of handling all types of commodities and provide services at par with global service standards. It will have state-of-the-art equipment/MHS and 100% security-controlled environment. Two of the upcoming ICTs in its portfolio are Ahmedabad ICT, which is expected to be operational by 3rd quarter FY 2025 and NMIA ICT, which is set to become one of the biggest cargo terminal facilities in the company's portfolio as well as in the country.

